BRIGHTWATER ROBOTICS, INC.

Employee Handbook

Part 2: Time Off, Leave, and Benefits

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Effective	January 1, 2026	**Owner**	People Team
Applies to	All employees in the US and Canada	**Supersedes**	Handbook v4.1 (2025)

1. Paid Time Off (PTO)

1.1 How Much PTO You Receive

Brightwater uses a single PTO bank for vacation, personal days, and errands. Sick leave is separate (see Section 4). Your annual PTO depends on your completed years of service and is granted in full on January 1 of each year.

Completed years of service	Annual PTO days	Annual PTO hours (8-hour days)
Less than 3 years (0 to 2 completed)	18 days	144 hours
3 years to less than 6 years	23 days	184 hours
6 years to less than 10 years	28 days	224 hours
10 or more years	33 days	264 hours

New hires receive PTO on their start date, prorated for the number of full months remaining in the calendar year and rounded up to the nearest half day. Your service tier changes on January 1 of the calendar year in which you reach the anniversary.

1.2 Requesting Time Off

- Submit requests in Harbor. Your manager will respond within 3 business days.
- Any absence of **5 or more consecutive working days** must be requested at least **14 days in advance**.
- Shorter absences should be requested as early as you can, ideally a week ahead.

1.3 Carryover

You may carry over up to **7 unused PTO days** into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by **March 31**, or they expire. Brightwater does not pay out unused PTO when you leave, except where required by law.

1.4 The Pay It Forward Pool

Employees may donate up to 3 PTO days per year to the Pay It Forward Pool. Pool days are given to colleagues who have run out of paid leave because of a serious medical event or family emergency. Donations are made in Harbor and are anonymous.

2. Company Holidays

Brightwater observes 11 paid company holidays. These days do not use PTO.

Holiday	2026 date
New Year's Day	Thursday, January 1
Martin Luther King Jr. Day	Monday, January 19
Memorial Day	Monday, May 25
Juneteenth	Friday, June 19
Independence Day (observed)	Friday, July 3
Founders' Day	Friday, August 14
Labor Day	Monday, September 7
Thanksgiving Day	Thursday, November 26
Day after Thanksgiving	Friday, November 27
Christmas Eve	Thursday, December 24
Christmas Day	Friday, December 25

2.1 Winter Reset

Brightwater closes for the Winter Reset from **Monday, December 28 through Thursday, December 31, 2026**. Winter Reset days are paid and do not use PTO. Employees on critical on-call rotations will be given a different day off.

> **Toronto office.** Employees in Toronto observe Ontario statutory holidays in place of Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Juneteenth, Founders' Day, and the day after Thanksgiving, and receive substitute days off as published each year in Harbor.

3. Otter Day

In honor of Bolt, every employee receives **one paid day off during the month of their birthday**, called Otter Day. It is separate from PTO. Otter Day must be taken within your birthday month. It does not carry over and is not paid out. If your birthday falls on a weekend or holiday, you may choose any workday in that month. Request it in Harbor like any other time off.

4. Sick and Safe Leave

You receive **10 sick days (80 hours) per calendar year**, granted on January 1. You may use sick leave for your own illness or injury, medical appointments, caring for a family member, and for safe leave related to domestic violence or stalking.

- Notify your manager before the start of your workday if you can.
- A doctor's note is required only after **3 or more consecutive** sick days.
- Unused sick days do not carry over and are not paid out.

5. Parental Leave

Brightwater provides fully paid parental leave for the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. You are eligible after **90 days of employment**.

Leave type	Paid weeks	Pay level
Primary caregiver	16 weeks	100% of base pay
Secondary caregiver	8 weeks	100% of base pay

- Leave must begin within 12 months of the birth or placement and may be taken in up to 2 blocks.
- Birth parents may also receive medical recovery leave as certified by a doctor. During medical recovery, short-term disability pays 60% of base pay.
- **Ramp-Back:** after your leave ends, you may work at 80% of your normal hours for up to 4 weeks while still receiving 100% of your base pay.

6. Other Leave

Type of leave	What you receive
Bereavement	5 paid days for a spouse, partner, child, parent, or sibling. 2 paid days for other extended family.
Jury duty	Full pay for up to 10 workdays.
Voting	Up to 2 paid hours if polls are not open outside your working hours.
Military leave	As required by law. Brightwater pays the difference between military pay and base pay for up to 30 days per year.
Volunteer time (Tide Hours)	24 paid hours per calendar year to volunteer with a registered nonprofit. Log your hours in Harbor.
Medical leave of absence	FMLA (US) for up to 12 weeks after 12 months of employment and 1,250 hours worked. Canadian employees follow provincial law.

7. Health Benefits

7.1 Medical Plans

Brightwater offers three medical plans. The company pays **90% of the employee-only premium** and **70% of the premium for dependents**. The premiums below are the employee's share for employee-only coverage, per biweekly paycheck.

Plan	Type	Deductible (individual)	Out-of-pocket max (individual)	Employee-only premium per paycheck
Cascade	High-deductible plan with HSA	$1,800	$4,500	$38
Rainier	PPO	$750	$3,500	$94
Olympic	HMO	$500	$3,000	$71

Employees who choose Cascade receive a Brightwater contribution to their Health Savings Account of $750 per year for individual coverage or $1,500 per year for family coverage.

7.2 Dental and Vision

Brightwater pays 100% of employee-only dental and vision premiums. Adding dependents costs $18 per paycheck for dental and $6 per paycheck for vision.

7.3 When Coverage Starts and Enrollment

- Enroll within **30 days** of your hire date. Coverage starts on the **first of the month after your hire date**. If you are hired on the first day of a month, coverage starts that day.
- Annual open enrollment runs **November 1 through November 15**.
- Qualifying life events (marriage, birth, loss of other coverage) allow changes within 30 days of the event.

8. Retirement: 401(k)

You can contribute to the Brightwater 401(k) from your first day. Employees are automatically enrolled at 5% of pay after 30 days unless they opt out. Roth and pre-tax options are both available.

8.1 Company Match

Brightwater matches **100% of the first 4% of eligible pay** you contribute, plus **50% of the next 2%**. The maximum company match is therefore 5% of eligible pay. The match is calculated each pay period, with an annual true-up.

8.2 Vesting

Years of service	Vested percentage of company match
Less than 1 year	0%
1 year	33%
2 years	67%
3 or more years	100%

Your own contributions are always 100% yours.

9. Learning, Wellness, and Other Perks

Perk	Amount	Details
Learning Stipend	$1,800 per calendar year	Courses, books, certifications, and exam fees. Unused amounts do not roll over. Conference registration is charged to your team's budget under the Travel and Expense Policy and does not use the stipend.
Wellness Wallet	$50 per month	Gym memberships, fitness apps, or meditation apps. Claim in Ledgerly.
Commuter benefit	$100 per month	Transit passes or vanpool. Available in all three offices.
Home office stipend	$750 one time plus $40 per month internet	See Part 3, Section 4.3.
Family Building Benefit	Up to $10,000 lifetime	Fertility treatment, adoption, and surrogacy expenses.

10. Employee Assistance Program

The Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provides free, confidential counseling and support for you and your household. You receive **8 free sessions per issue per year**. The EAP line is available 24 hours a day at 1-800-555-0119.

Brightwater Robotics, Inc. is a fictional company created for training and demonstration purposes. All policies, figures, systems, names, phone numbers, and addresses in this document are invented.